

GLOBAL STEEL

The steel market barometer: May Update

Big picture: The steel & iron ore navigator

Key latest datapoints

- **Global flat steel prices:** In April, average HRC prices increased in virtually all analyzed regions with Brazil printing the stronger increase (+10% m/m), followed by Japan (+6.5% m/m), then China (+2.9% m/m), the US (+2.4% m/m), and the Black Sea (+2% m/m), while in EU it was broadly flattish (+0.3% m/m). On a YTD basis, Brazil's HRC steel price performance has been the strongest in our sample (+21%), followed by the US (+15%) with other regions also showing price increases from 6%–13%. From early April to early May, HRC prices rose for all regions except for the EU and the Black Sea (both flattish), up by +2%/+3%/+7%/+10% in the US/China/Japan/Brazil.
- **Global long steel prices:** In April, average rebar prices increased for all regions ex-US (flattish). Brazil's performance was the strongest once again (+12% m/m), followed by EU (+6.9% m/m), then the Black Sea (+6.1% m/m), Japan (+4.5% m/m), and China (+2.3% m/m). On a YTD basis, Brazil's rebar prices also saw the best performance (+13%), followed by EU (+10.6%), China (+7.8%), the Black Sea (+6% m/m), and Japan (+3.7%), while prices are flat in the US. From early April to Early May, rebar prices rose for all regions except for the US and Black Sea (flattish), up by +2%/+5%/+5%/+12% in China/EU/Japan/Brazil.
- **China:** China's steel production continued to decline y/y in the first two weeks of May (-3.2% y/y vs the same week in 2025). According to GS's China Basic Materials team [commentary](#), *"on the industry level, while the anti-involution effort and long-term capacity cut plan for the Chinese steel sector remain intact, we see delayed execution in 2026E in terms of both capacity and production discipline."*
- **Europe:** In March, EU crude steel production increased 16% m/m (above the historical seasonality for the month of +10% m/m on avg from 2026-2025), but it declined by 3% y/y and YTD.
- **US:** In April, US avg weekly steel production (7.3Mst) increased by 3% m/m and utilization rates averaged 79.6% (+2 p.p. m/m and + 4.4 p.p. y/y).

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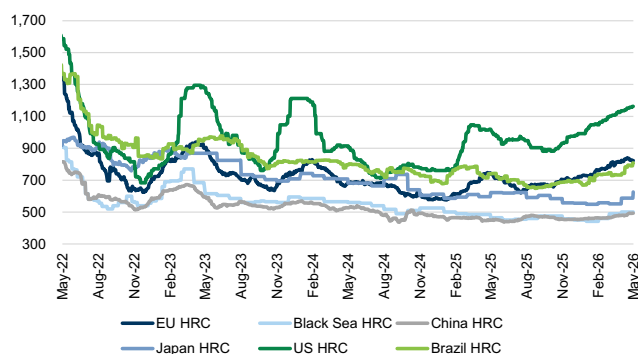
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- **LatAm:** In March, LatAm crude steel production declined by 3% y/y (-2% y/y YTD in 1Q26), but increased by 16% m/m (above the +6% m/m historical avg seasonality for the month).
- **RoW:** In March, India's crude steel production growth accelerated to 11% y/y (vs +10% y/y YTD and +7% y/y in Feb). In Japan and the Black Sea, crude steel production declined by 4% y/y and 3% y/y, respectively, while on a monthly basis, it increased by +8%/10% m/m, respectively, both in line with historical seasonality.

Global Steel Indicators

Steel Prices

Flat Steel

Exhibit 1: HRC Prices in major regions
\$/t

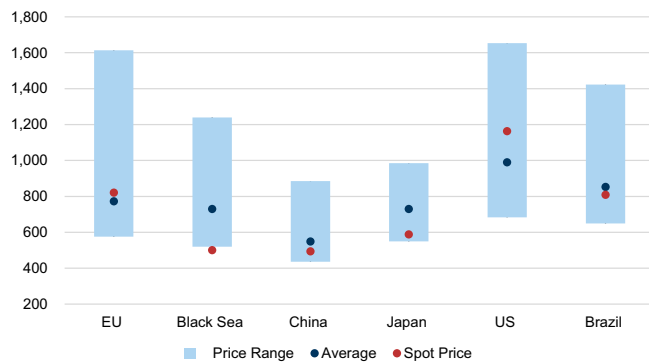
Source: S&P Global Platts, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: HRC 1m/YTD price performance, \$ terms

	HRC Price Performance		
	Spot	M/M	YTD
EU	821	0.3%	12.6%
Black Sea	500	2.0%	11.1%
China	493	2.9%	7.4%
Japan	587	6.5%	5.7%
US	1,163	2.4%	14.7%
Brazil	808	10.3%	20.6%

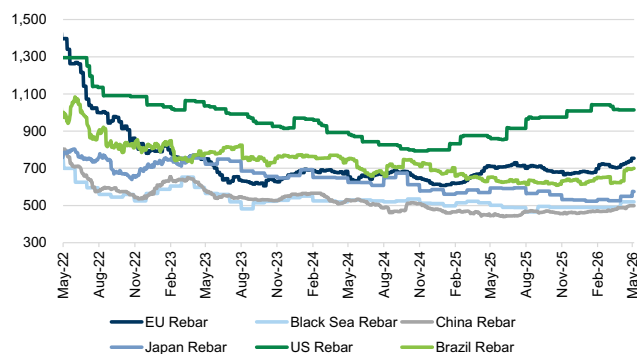
Data for April 2026

Source: S&P Global Platts, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: HRC price ranges in the past 4 years
US\$/t

Source: S&P Global Platts, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Long Steel

Exhibit 4: Rebar prices in major regions
\$/t

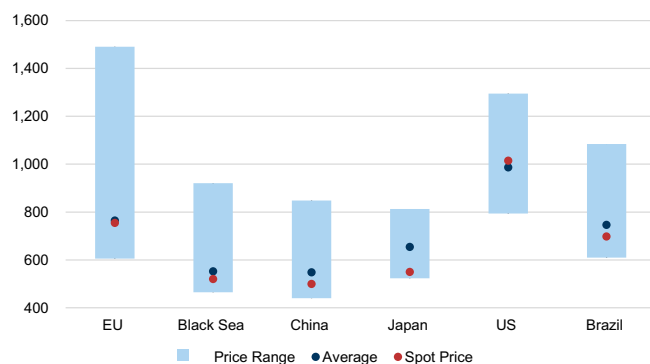
Source: S&P Global Platts, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: Rebar 1m/YTD price performance, \$ terms
%

Rebar Price Performance			
	Spot	M/M	YTD
EU	754	6.9%	10.6%
Black Sea	520	6.1%	6.1%
China	499	2.3%	7.8%
Japan	550	4.5%	3.7%
US	1,014	0.0%	0.5%
Brazil	698	12.0%	13.3%

Data for April 2026

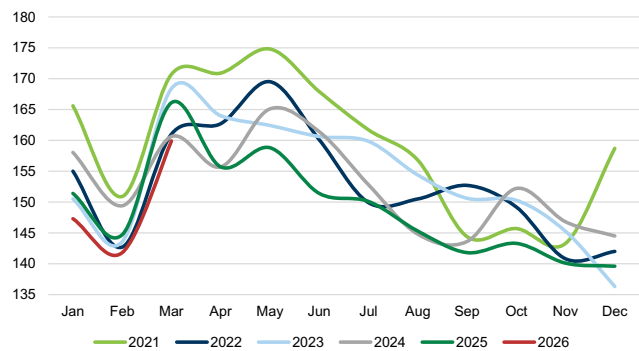
Source: S&P Global Platts, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 6: Rebar price ranges in the past 4 years
US\$/t

Source: S&P Global Platts, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

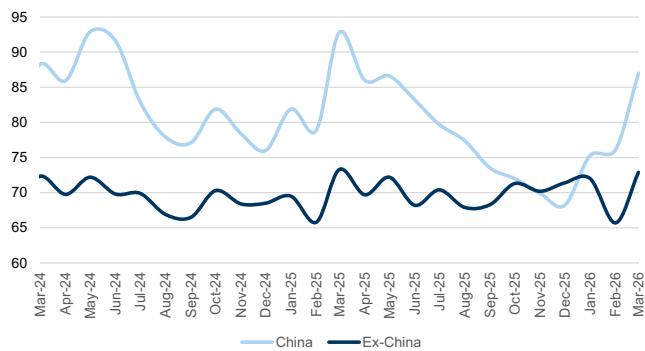
Output

Exhibit 7: Global crude steel
mn tonnes (monthly)



Source: World Steel Association, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

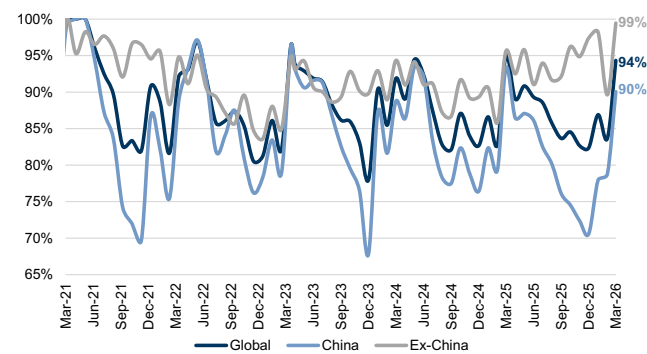
Exhibit 8: Global crude steel production, China/ex-China
mn tonnes (monthly)



Source: World Steel Association, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

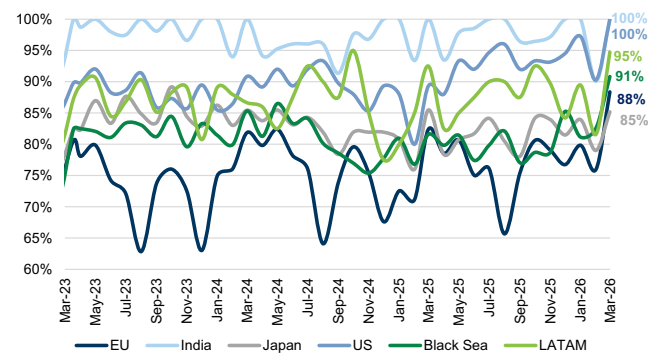
Capacity

Exhibit 9: Effective steel capacity utilization
Latest monthly output as % of peak output (since 2022)



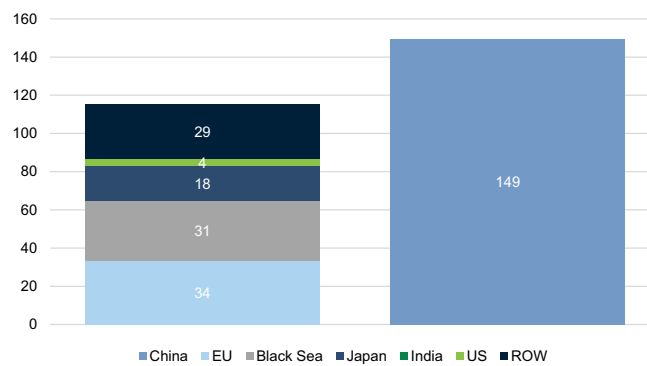
Source: World Steel Association, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 10: Ex-China effective steel capacity utilization
Latest monthly output as % of peak output (since 2022)



Source: World Steel Association, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 11: Annualized spare capacity by region
mn tonnes



Source: World Steel Association, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

China Steel Indicators

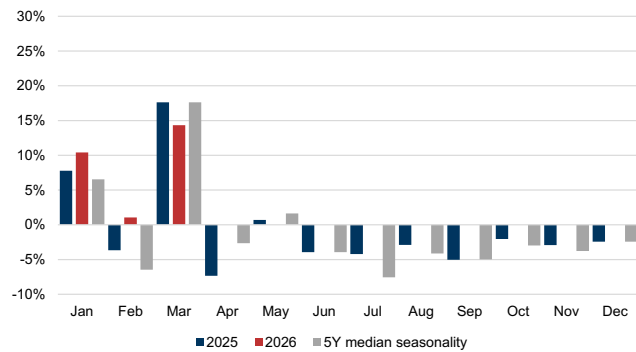
Steel Output

Exhibit 12: Steel production remained stable over the past week



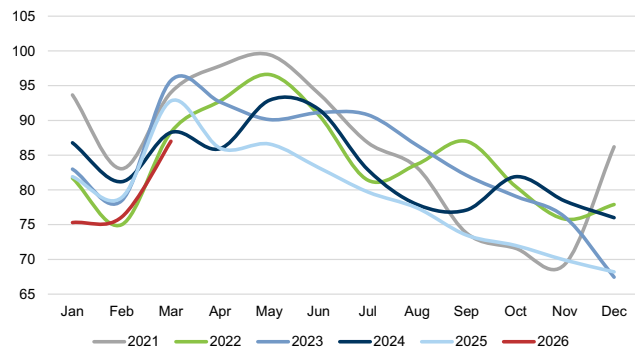
Source: Mysteel, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 13: China crude steel output change % m/m vs 5Y median trend



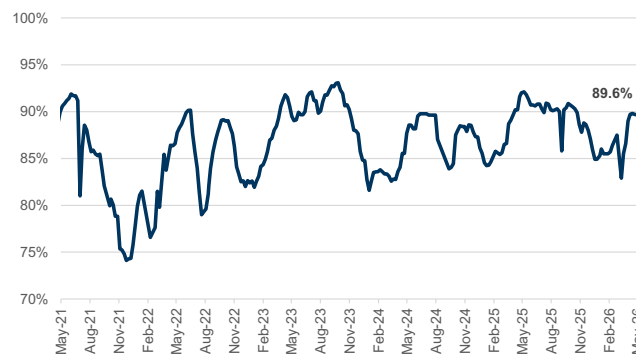
Source: CISA, Mysteel, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 14: China's monthly crude steel production increased 14% m/m but decreased -6% y/y in March'26 mn tonnes



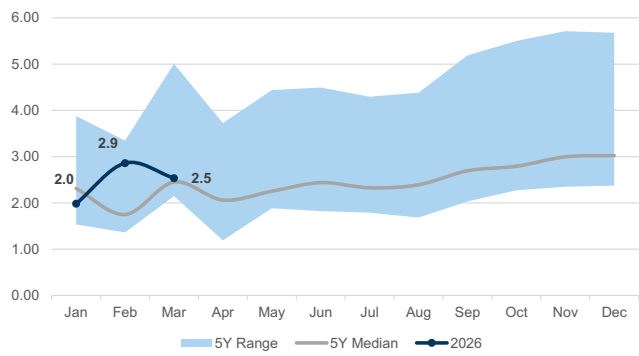
Source: World Steel Association, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 15: China’s Blast Furnace capacity utilization rate %



Source: CISA, Mysteel, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

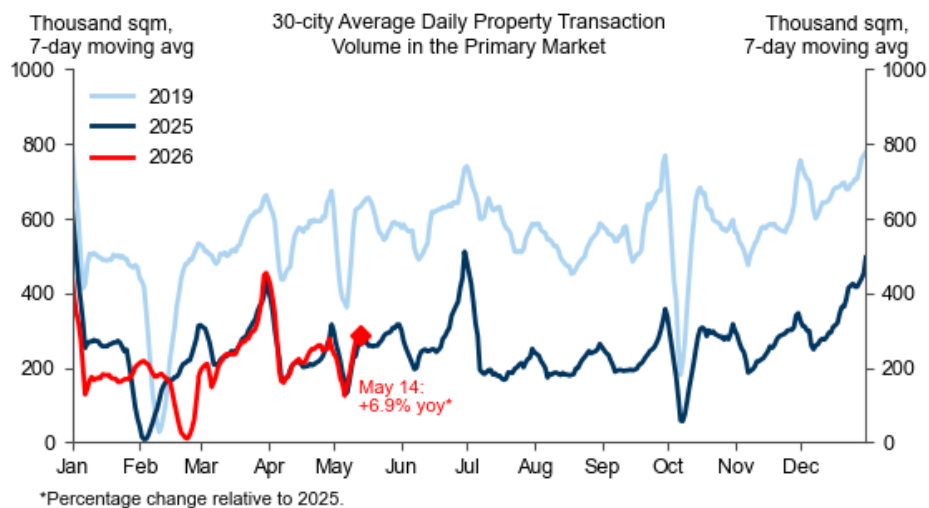
Exhibit 16: China auto production (mn units)



Source: Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

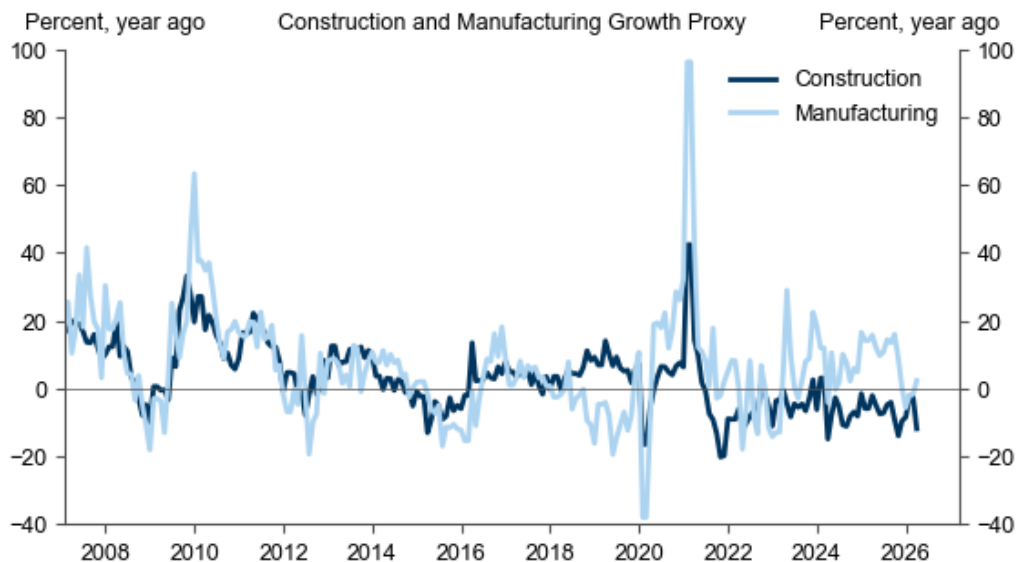
Macro/property indicators

Exhibit 17: 30-city daily property transaction volume in the primary market increased over the last week and was above year-ago level



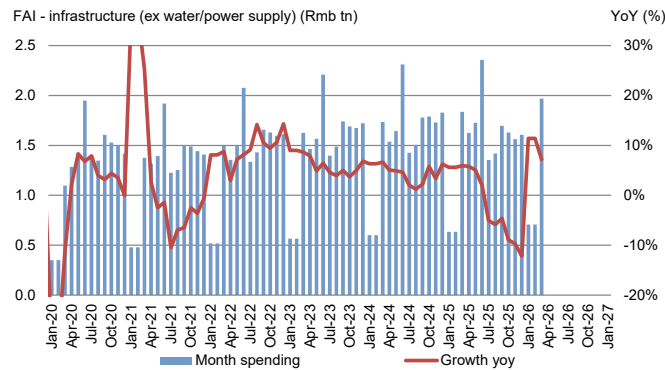
Source: Wind, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 18: Our manufacturing growth proxy increased in March while our construction growth proxy fell



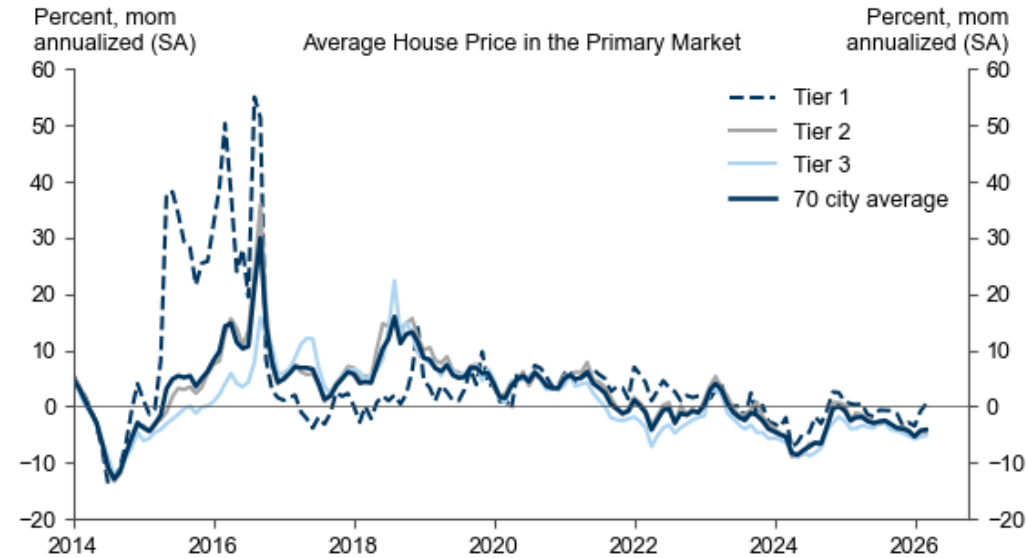
Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 19: FAI-infrastructure (ex water/power supply) increased 8.9% yoy in 3M26, implying a increased of 7.2% in March-26



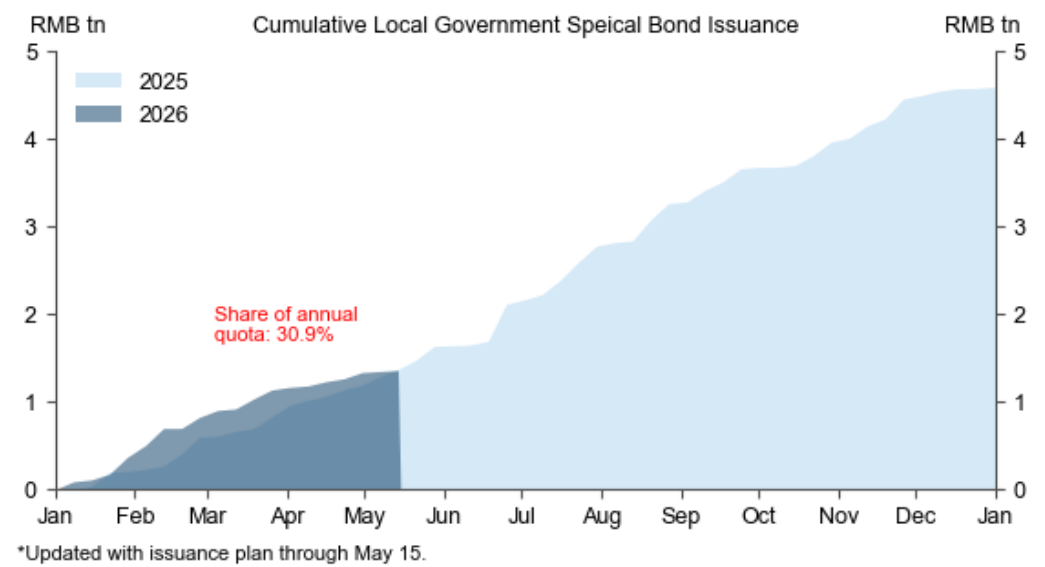
Source: CEIC, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 20: In the primary market, the sequential decline in 70-city weighted average property price eased to 4.1% mom annualized in March



Source: NBS, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

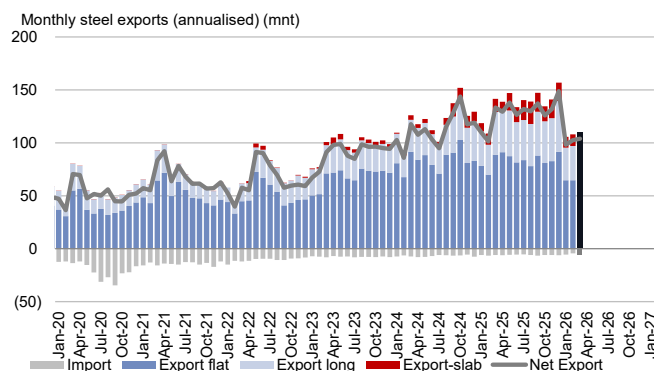
Exhibit 21: RMB 1.36bn local government special bonds have been issued year-to-date



Source: Wind, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

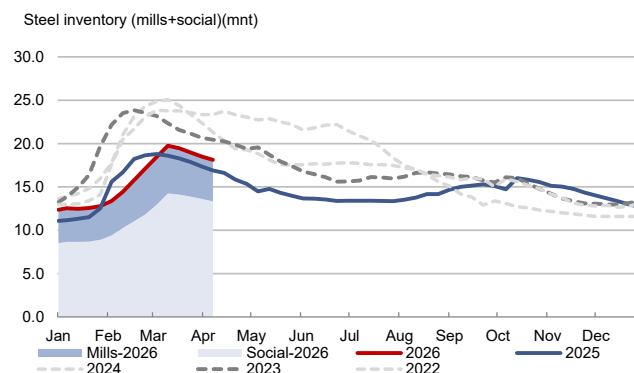
Steel Trade & Demand

Exhibit 22: Monthly steel trade – China



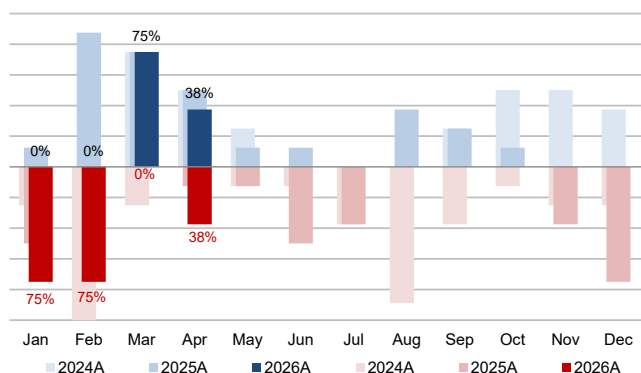
Source: CEIC, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 23: Steel inventory – social inventory and mills update



Source: Wind, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 24: Channel checks – steel orderbook trend



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

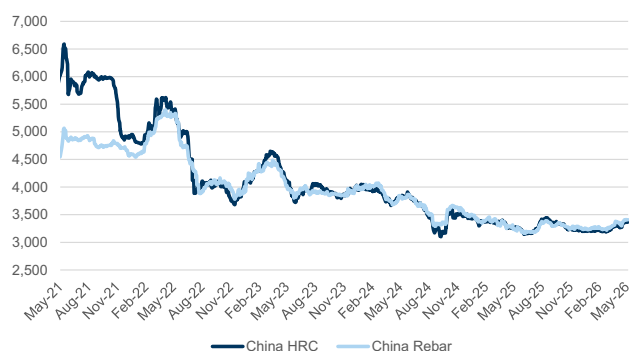
Exhibit 25: Steel demand edged up over the past week



Source: Mysteel, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

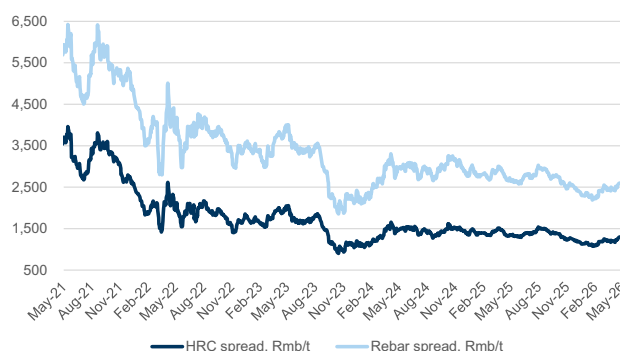
Steelmakers' profitability

Exhibit 26: Chinese HRC prices increased 2% m/m and Rebar 1% m/m
RMB/t



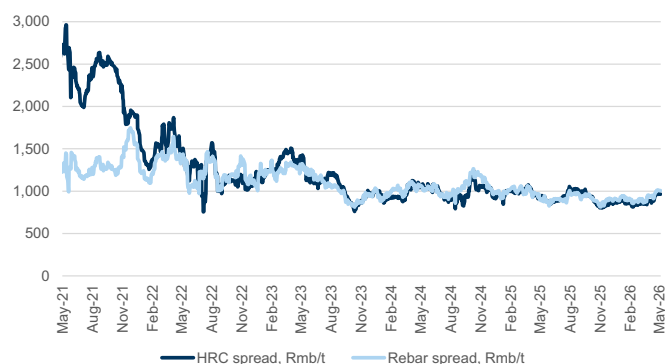
Source: S&P Global Platts, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 27: BF ferrous feed spreads increased 9% m/m for HRC and 3% m/m Rebar in April...
BF ferrous feed, RMB/t



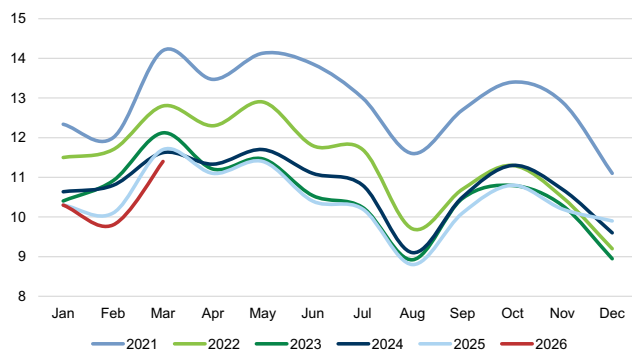
Source: S&P Global Platts, Datastream, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 28: ...continuing higher than EAF ferrous feeds
RMB/t

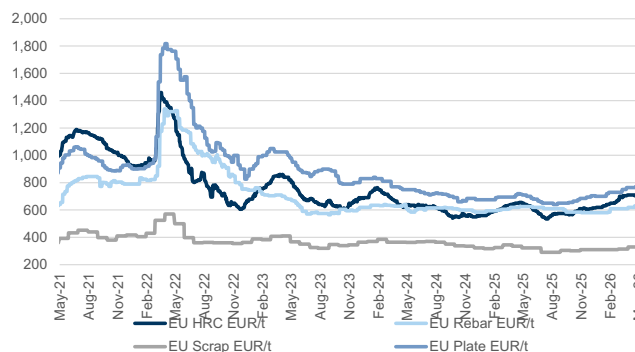


Source: S&P Global Platts, Datastream, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

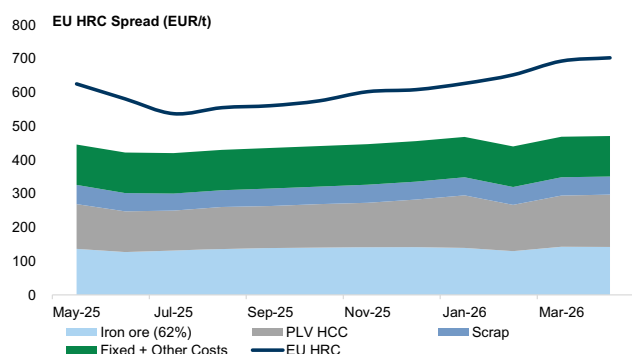
Europe Steel Indicators

Exhibit 29: EU monthly crude steel production
mn tonnes

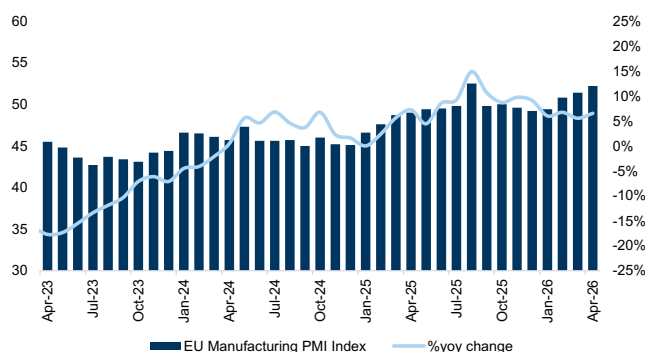
Source: World Steel Association, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 30: Europe Steel Prices
EUR/t

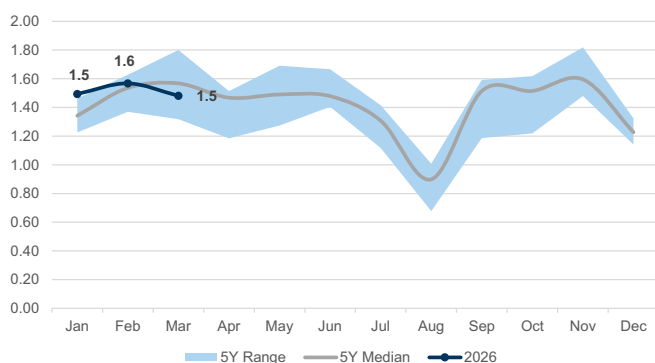
Source: S&P Global Platts, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 31: Europe ferrous feed spreads
EUR/t

Source: S&P Global Platts, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 32: EU manufacturing PMI Index (lhs), % chg yoy (rhs)

Source: S&P Global Market Intelligence, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

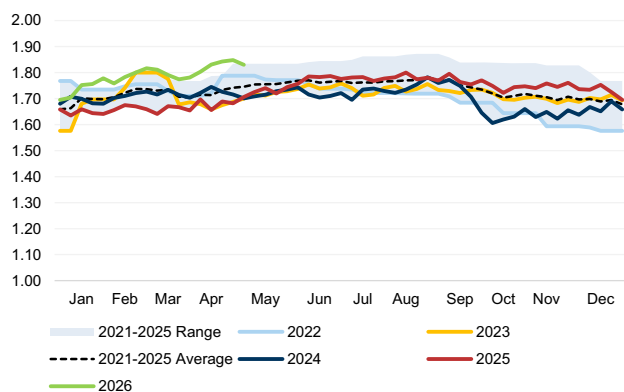
Exhibit 33: EU monthly auto production (mn units)

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Bloomberg

US Steel Indicators

Exhibit 34: US steel production

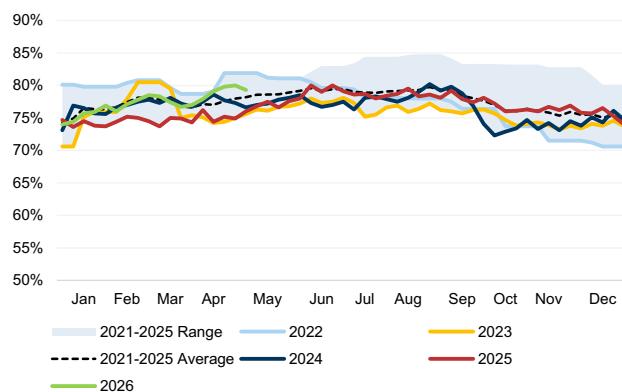
mn st



Source: World Steel Association, Eurofer, S&P Global Platts, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 35: US steel production capacity utilization

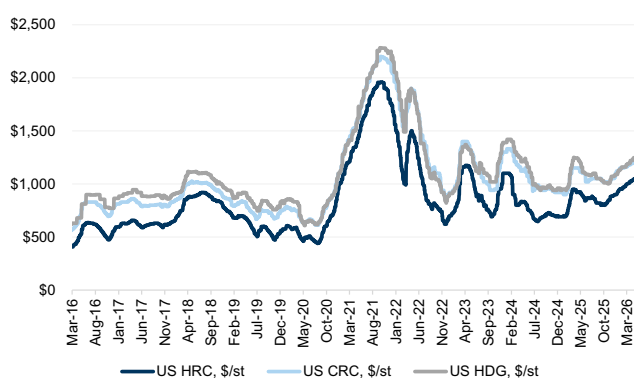
%



Source: World Steel Association, Eurofer, S&P Global Platts, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 36: US steel prices

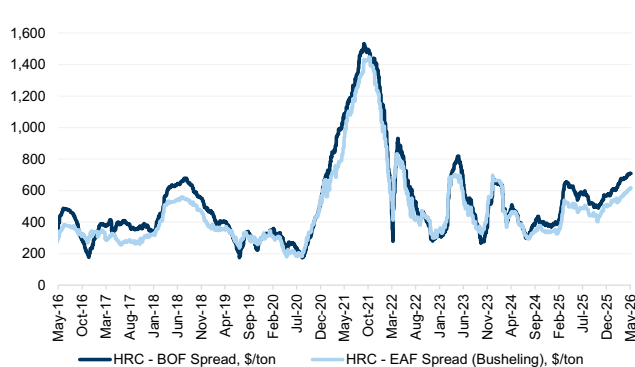
\$/st



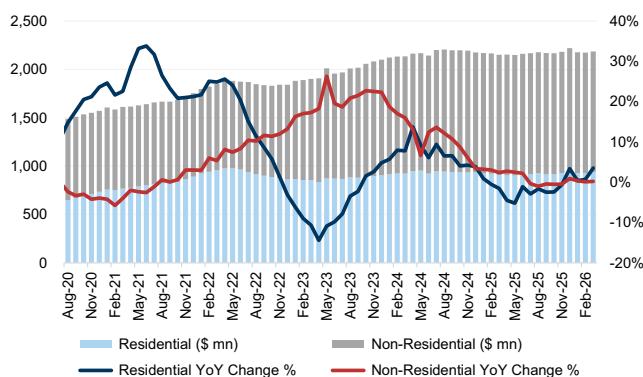
Source: S&P Global Platts, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 37: HRC-BOF and HRC-EAF spreads

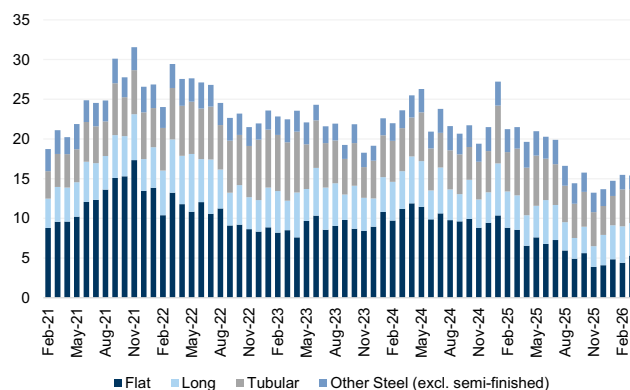
\$/st



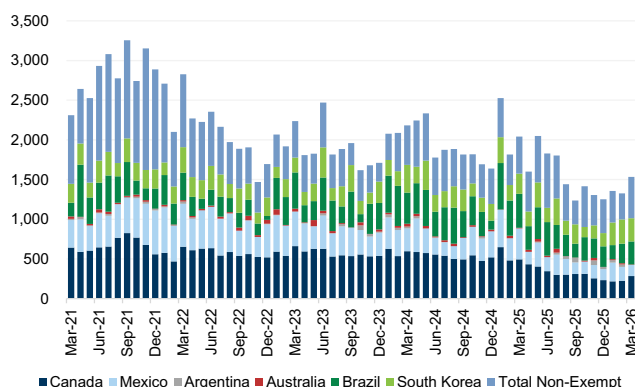
Source: S&P Global Platts, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 38: US Total construction (\$ bn) spending and change YoY %

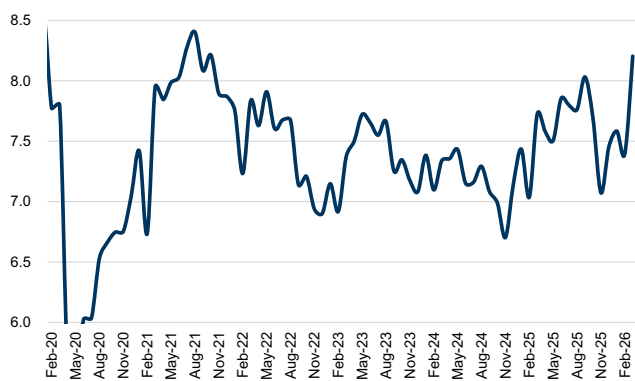
Source: CRU Group, US Census Bureau, Baker Hughes, AISI, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 39: Annualised steel imports (mn st)

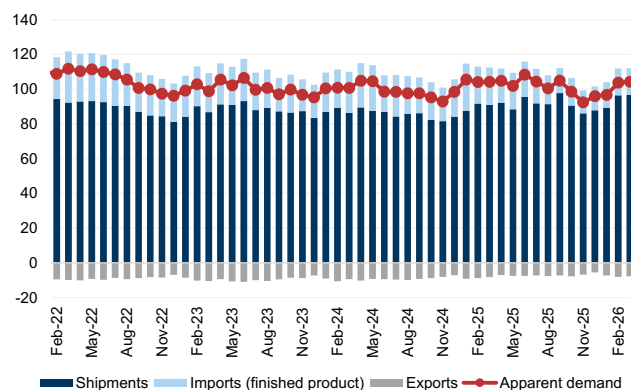
Source: US Census Bureau, AISI, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 40: Monthly steel imports by region (k st)

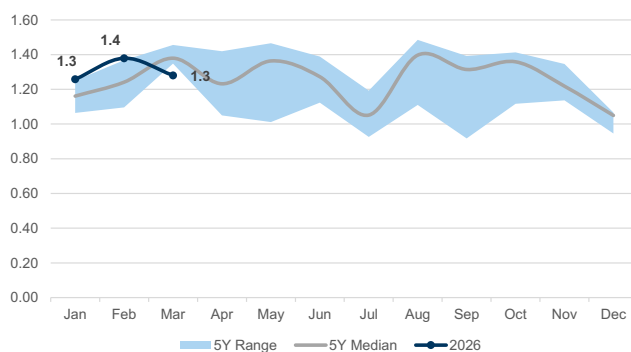
Source: US Census Bureau, AISI, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 42: Total steel shipments mn st

Source: US Census Bureau, AISI, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

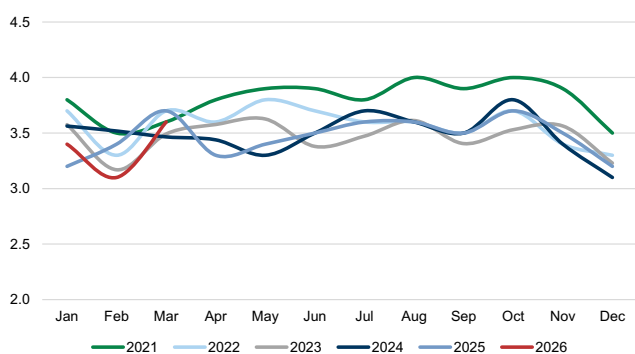
Exhibit 41: Annualized monthly apparent demand (mn tons)

Source: US Census Bureau, AISI, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

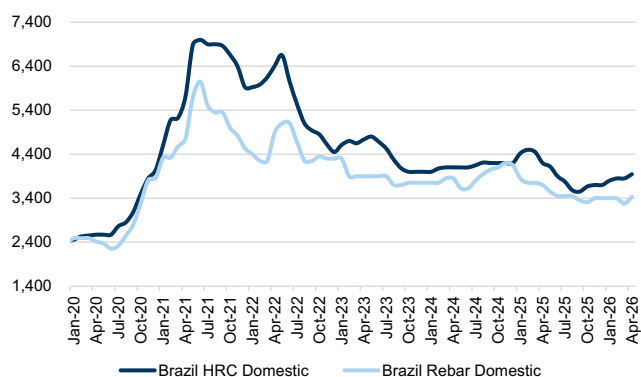
Exhibit 43: North America auto production mn units

Source: Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

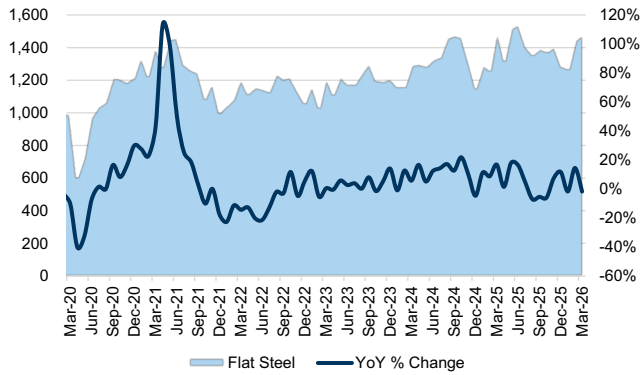
Latin America Steel Indicators

Exhibit 44: LatAm crude steel production mn tonnes

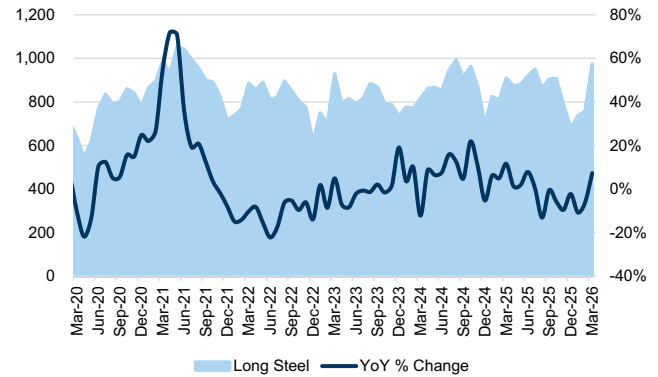
Source: World Steel Association, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 45: Brazil steel prices (R\$/t)

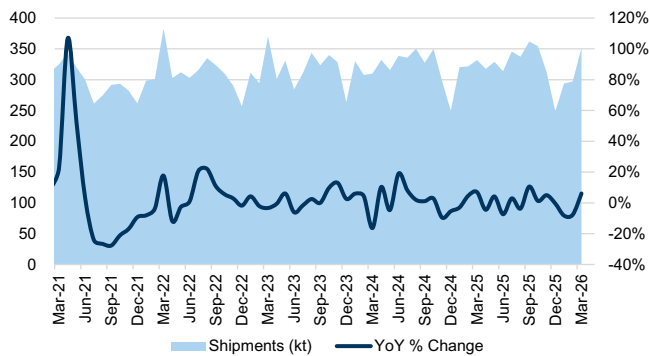
Source: Platts

Exhibit 46: Brazil's Flat Steel Apparent Consumption (kt)

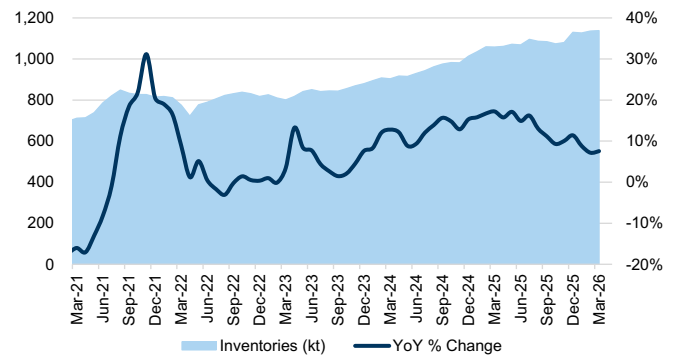
Source: IABR

Exhibit 47: Brazil's Long Steel Apparent Consumption (kt)

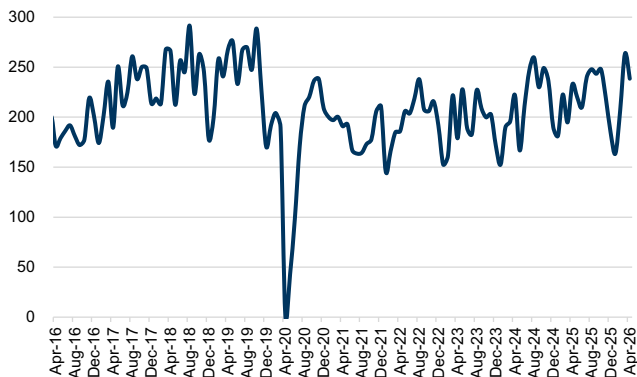
Source: IABR

Exhibit 48: Brazilian steel distributors' shipments (kt)

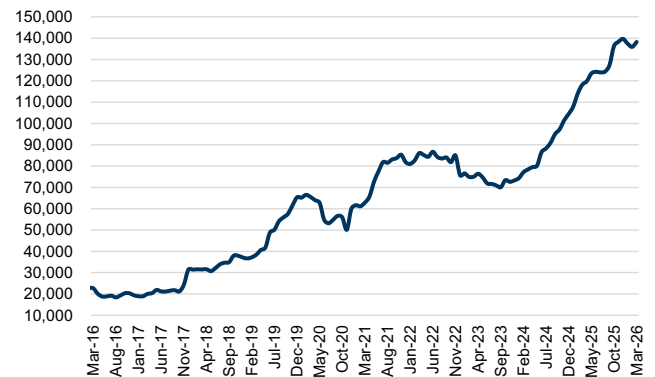
Source: INDIA

Exhibit 49: Brazilian steel distributors' inventories (kt)

Source: INDIA

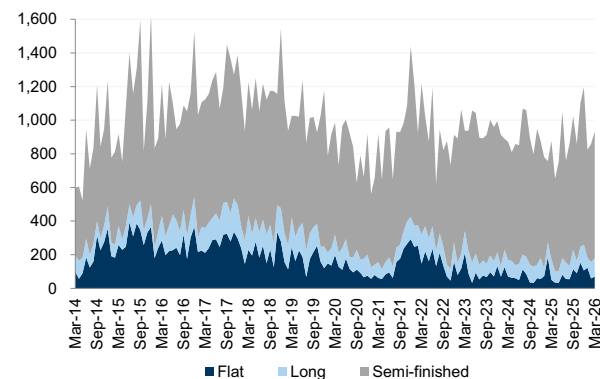
Exhibit 50: Brazil's Auto Production (k units)

Source: ANFAVEA

Exhibit 51: Sao Paulo Real Estate LTM Launches (units)

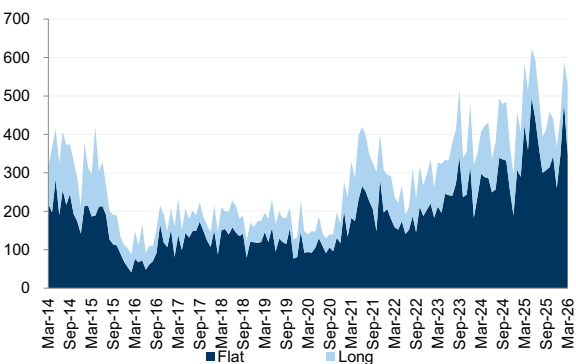
Source: SECOVI

Exhibit 52: Brazil's steel export sales breakdown (kt)



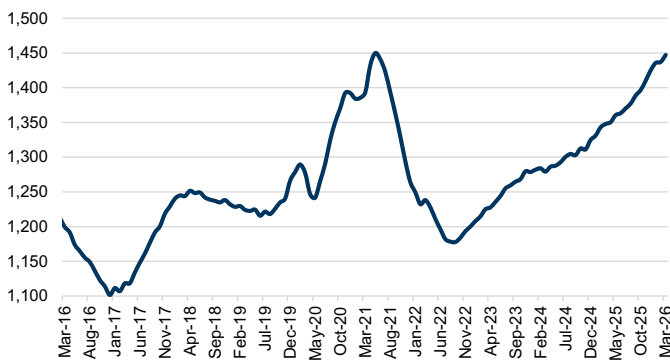
Source: IABR

Exhibit 53: Brazil's steel imports breakdown (kt)



Source: IABR

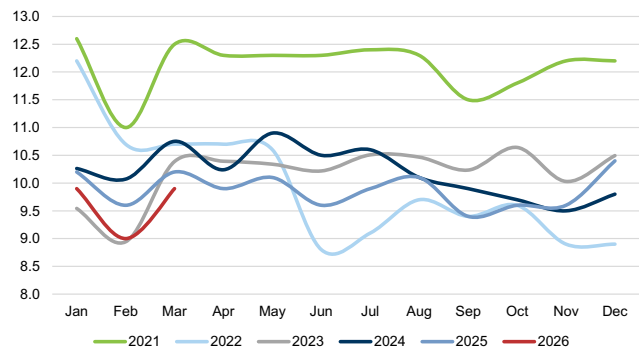
Exhibit 54: Brazil's LTM White goods sales volume index



Source: IBGE

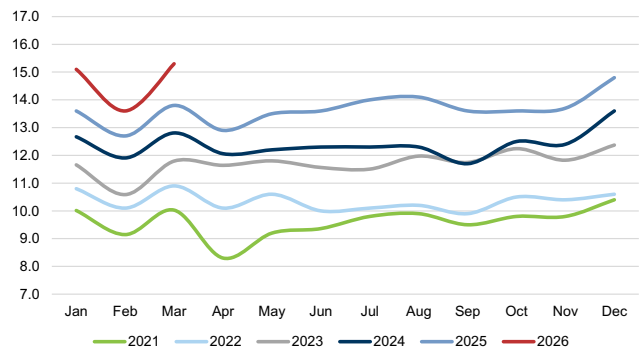
Rest of World: Black Sea, Japan & India steel indicators

Exhibit 55: Black Sea crude steel production
mn tonnes



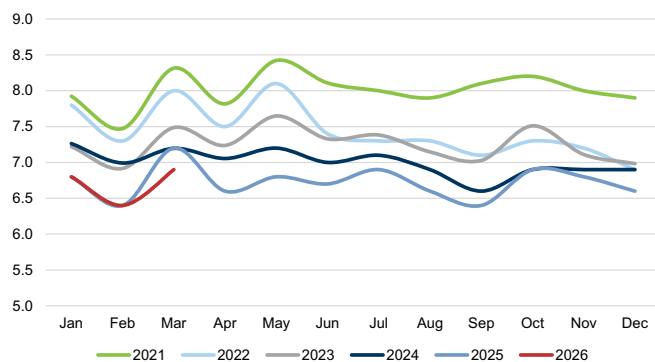
Source: World Steel Association, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 56: India crude steel production
mn tonnes



Source: World Steel Association, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

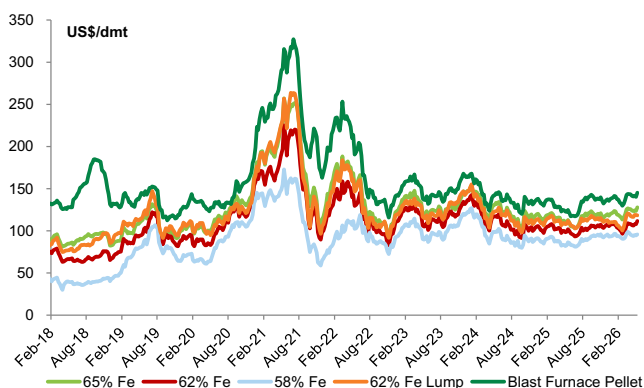
Exhibit 57: Japan crude steel production
mn tonnes



Source: World Steel Association, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

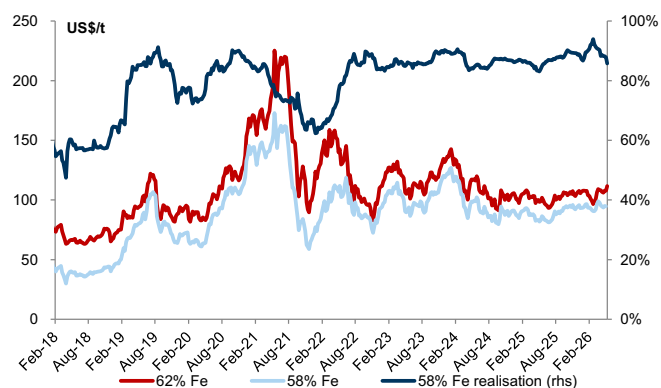
Pricing and Penalties

Exhibit 58: Seaborne iron ore and pellet prices (CIF China)
US\$/dmt



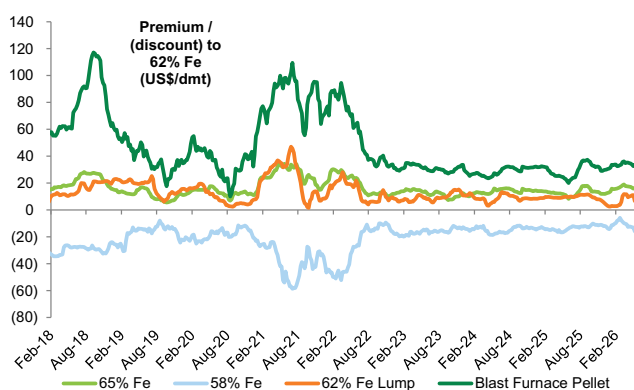
Source: S&P Global Platts, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 59: 58% Fe price realisations
US\$/t



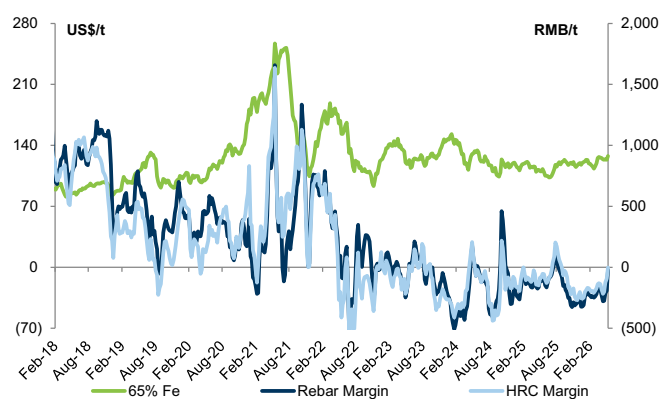
Source: S&P Global Platts, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 60: High / low grade iron ore premiums / vs 62% Fe
US\$/dmt



Source: S&P Global Platts, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

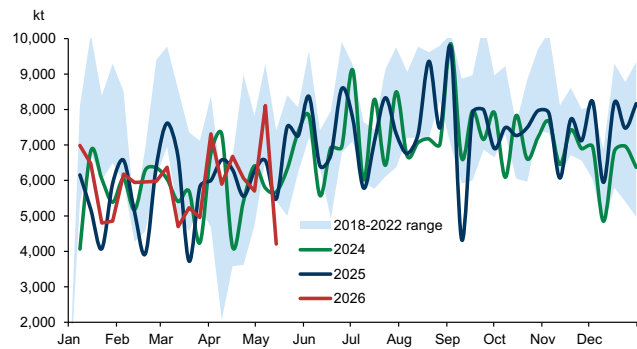
Exhibit 61: Iron ore pricing vs. Rebar and HRC margin
US\$/t



Source: S&P Global Platts, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

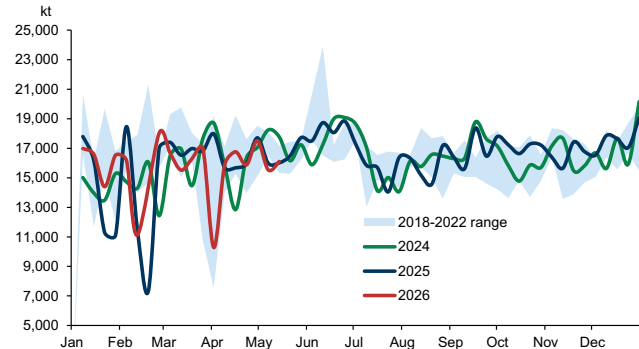
Iron ore: Seaborne trade

Exhibit 62: Brazilian iron ore shipments
kt



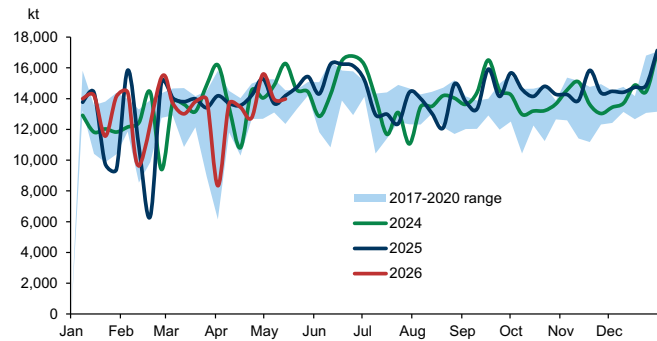
Source: S&P Global Platts, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 63: Australian iron ore shipments
kt



Source: S&P Global Platts, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

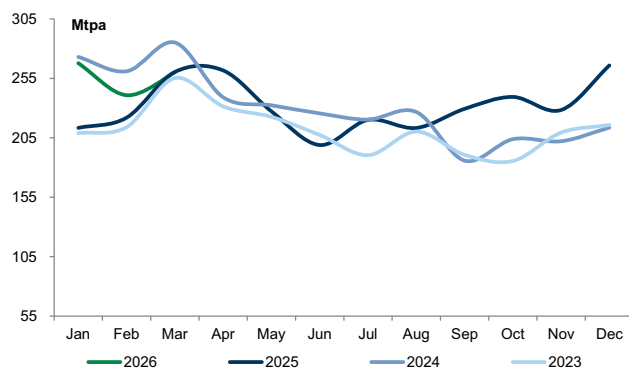
Exhibit 64: Australian shipments to China
kt



Source: S&P Global Platts, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

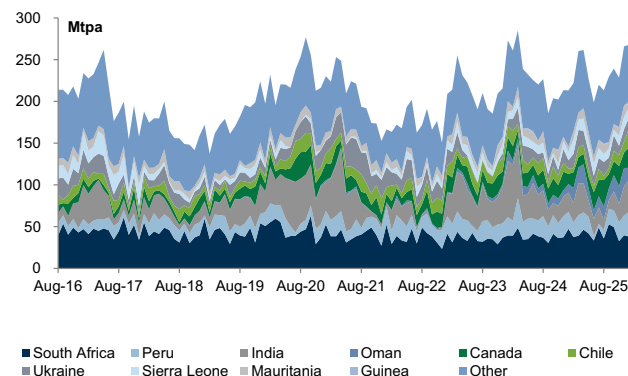
China Iron Ore Imports (ex Aus/Brazil) and domestic production and stocks

Exhibit 65: China imports - ex Aus/Brazil
mtpa



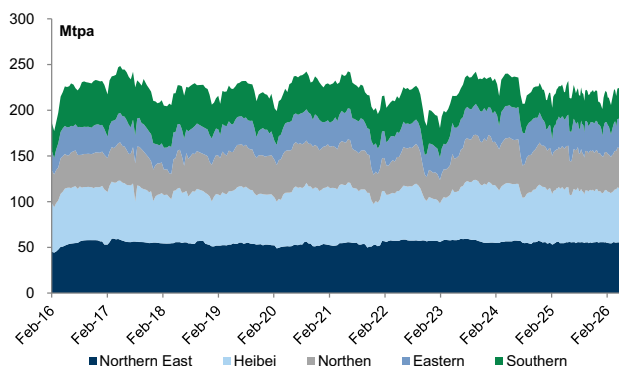
Source: Mysteel, China NBS, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 66: China ex Aus/Brazil iron ore imports by country
Mtpa



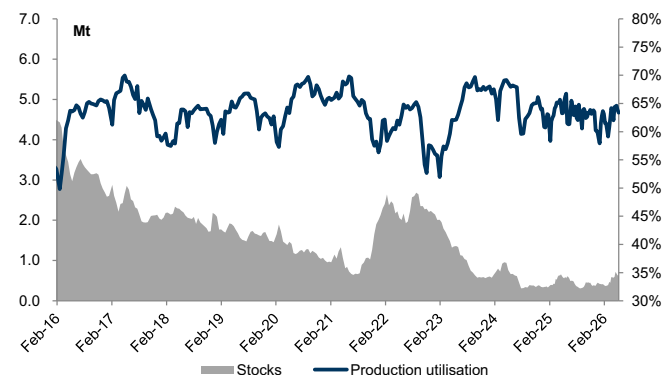
Source: Mysteel, China NBS, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 67: China domestic iron ore production by region (62% FeEq)
Mtpa



Source: Mysteel, China NBS, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

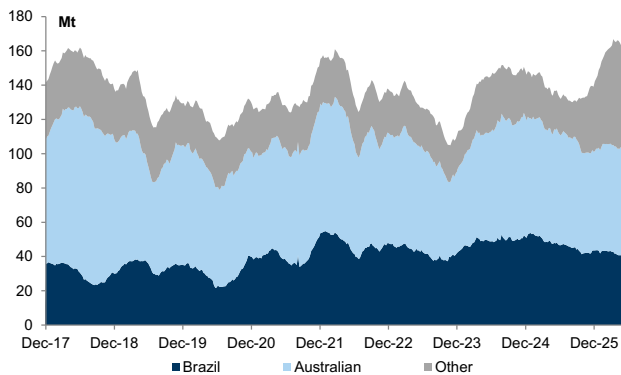
Exhibit 68: Domestic miner iron ore stocks and utilisation rates
Mt



Source: Mysteel, China NBS, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

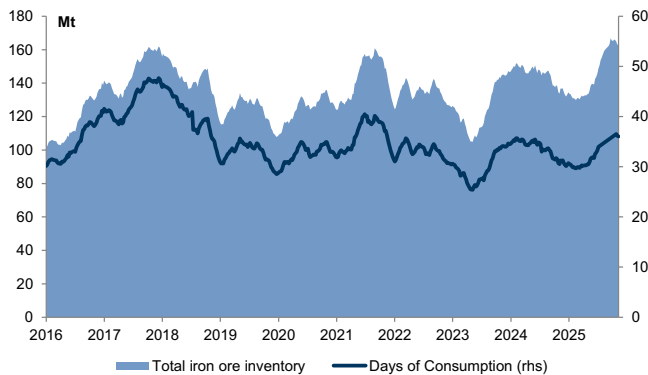
Chinese port inventories

Exhibit 69: China portside iron ore stockpiles
Mt



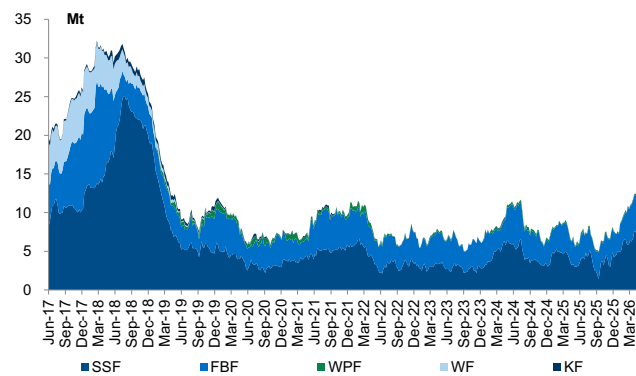
Source: Mysteel, Steelhome, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 70: We calculate around 5 weeks of inventory
Mt



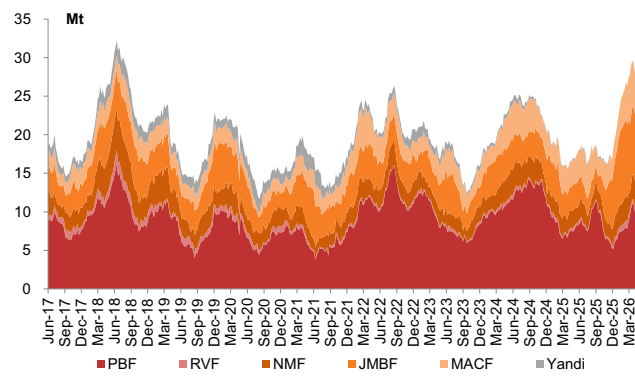
Source: Mysteel, Steelhome, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 71: FMG branded fines stockpile
Mt



Source: Mysteel, Steelhome, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 72: BHP & RIO inventories
Mt



Source: Mysteel, Steelhome, Bloomberg, Data Compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

GS Projections and equity views

GS Global steel prices outlook

Exhibit 73: GS Global Steel Price Outlook

	Units	SPOT	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026E	1Q26	2Q26E	3Q26E	4Q26E
China													
HRC	Rmb/t	3,439	3,898	5,420	4,503	4,085	3,805	3,296	3,363	3,228	3,363	3,363	3,363
YoY / QoQ	%		1%	39%	-17%	-9%	-7%	-13%	2%	-19%	4%	0%	0%
Rebar	Rmb/t	3,432	3,718	5,042	4,417	3,928	3,551	3,298	3,542	3,272	3,542	3,542	3,542
YoY / QoQ	%		-4%	36%	-12%	-11%	-10%	-7%	7%	-17%	8%	0%	0%
US													
HRC EXW Indiana	US\$/t	1,179	646	1,774	1,120	1,015	855	937	1,078	1,078	1,089	1,077	1,069
YoY / QoQ	%		8%	174%	-37%	-9%	-16%	10%	15%	17%	1%	-1%	-1%
Rebar EXW US Southeast	US\$/t	1,014	672	998	1,162	993	857	919	1,035	1,030	1,047	1,036	1,025
YoY / QoQ	%		2%	49%	16%	-15%	-14%	7%	13%	21%	2%	-1%	-1%
European													
HRC, EXW South and North	EUR/t	690	457	930	863	694	620	581	599	655	605	585	585
YoY / QoQ	%		-1%	104%	-7%	-25%	-28%	-6%	3%	2%	-8%	-3%	0%
Merchant bar, Europe dome	EUR/t	750	480	775	1,081	752	675	667	656	668	665	645	646
YoY / QoQ	%		-8%	61%	40%	-3%	-38%	-1%	-2%	-1%	0%	-3%	0%
Brazil													
HRC	R\$/t	4,025	2,941	6,170	5,546	4,416	4,137	3,962	3,931	3,831	3,950	3,950	3,995
YoY / QoQ	%		14%	110%	-10%	-28%	-6%	-4%	-1%	-4%	3%	0%	1%
Rebar	R\$/t	3,520	2,762	5,076	4,494	3,858	3,888	3,571	3,370	3,360	3,475	3,310	3,335
YoY / QoQ	%		1%	84%	-11%	-24%	1%	-8%	-6%	-10%	3%	-5%	1%

Source: S&P Global Platts, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Steel and Iron Ore Comparables

Exhibit 74: Steel and iron comparables

Steel														
Region	Company name	Analyst name	Curr	Price	PT	Upsd	Rating	MCap US\$bn	EV/EBITDA 2026E 2027E		Dividend yield 2027E		FCF yield 2026E 2027E	
North America	Nucor Corp.	Nick Cash	\$	232.85	260.00	12%	Buy	53	8.8x	7.2x	1.0%	1.0%	4.4%	7.2%
	Steel Dynamics Inc.	Nick Cash	\$	234.68	n.a.	n.a.	Not Rated	34	9.7x	7.8x	0.9%	0.9%	3.8%	8.3%
	Reliance Inc.	Nick Cash	\$	367.84	341.00	-7%	Neutral	19	12.0x	11.0x	1.4%	1.5%	5.9%	5.7%
	Cleveland-Cliffs Inc.	Nick Cash	\$	10.93	10.00	-9%	Neutral	6	10.5x	5.9x	0.0%	0.0%	-1.3%	11.6%
	Commercial Metals Co.	Nick Cash	\$	72.75	77.00	6%	Buy	8	7.9x	6.3x	1.0%	1.1%	3.4%	11.0%
	North America Average								9.8x	7.6x	0.9%	0.9%	3.2%	8.8%
Europe	ArcelorMittal SA	Matt Greene	\$	63.78	51.40	-19%	Neutral	48	6.9x	5.7x	1.2%	1.2%	1.9%	5.8%
	ArcelorMittal SA	Matt Greene	€	55.00	44.00	-20%	Neutral	49	7.0x	5.8x	1.2%	1.2%	1.9%	5.7%
	Europe Average								7.0x	5.8x	1.2%	1.2%	1.9%	5.7%
Latin America	Gerdau	Marcio Farid	R\$	23.58	25.00	6%	Buy	10	4.6x	4.3x	3.0%	3.0%	7.7%	7.1%
	Usiminas	Marcio Farid	R\$	9.89	6.60	-33%	Neutral	2	7.3x	5.7x	0.0%	2.2%	4.8%	9.2%
	Ternium	Marcio Farid	\$	44.17	49.00	11%	Buy	9	6.5x	4.8x	5.0%	5.0%	-10.0%	9.6%
	CSN	Marcio Farid	R\$	6.67	6.40	-4%	Sell	2	5.5x	6.8x	0.0%	0.0%	-59.3%	-60.9%
	CSN Mineracao	Marcio Farid	R\$	4.77	4.30	-10%	Sell	5	7.9x	13.8x	3.7%	0.0%	-15.4%	-21.1%
	Latin America Average								6.4x	7.1x	2.3%	2.0%	-14.4%	-11.2%
Asia	Baoshan Iron & Steel	Trina Chen	Rmb	6.22	7.50	21%	Neutral	20	5.0x	4.4x	5.2%	6.4%	7.3%	10.0%
	Angang Steel	Trina Chen	HK\$	1.41	1.20	-15%	Sell	2		10.7x	0.0%	0.0%	-32.4%	-1.3%
	Maanshan Iron & Steel	Trina Chen	HK\$	2.50	2.50	0%	Neutral	2	7.2x	5.9x	1.5%	2.9%	-0.7%	6.7%
	Asia Average								6.1x	7.0x	2.2%	3.1%	-8.6%	5.1%
Australia	Sims Metal Management Ltd.	Paul Young	A\$	22.48	22.20	-1%	Neutral	3	8.2x	6.4x	1.2%	0.9%	2.9%	6.5%
	BlueScope Steel	Paul Young	A\$	30.14	n.a.	n.a.	Not Rated	10	7.4x	6.8x	7.6%	4.8%	0.2%	5.9%
	Global Median								7.4x	6.4x	1.2%	1.2%	2.4%	6.9%
Bulks														
Region	Company name	Analyst name	Curr	Price	PT	Upsd	Rating	MCap US\$bn	EV/EBITDA 2026E 2027E		Dividend yield 2027E		FCF yield 2026E 2027E	
Global	BHP Group Ltd.	Paul Young	A\$	60.46	58.50	-3%	Buy	221	7.5x	8.7x	3.2%	2.6%	4.6%	3.4%
	Rio Tinto Ltd.	Paul Young	A\$	185.75	165.30	-11%	Neutral	218	8.3x	8.5x	3.2%	3.2%	3.5%	4.0%
	BHP Group Ltd.	Matt Greene	£	3,308.00	2,900.00	-12%	Neutral	225	7.6x	8.9x	3.2%	2.6%	4.5%	3.3%
	Rio Tinto Plc	Matt Greene	£	8,154.00	7,600.00	-7%	Neutral	179	6.9x	7.1x	3.9%	3.9%	4.3%	4.8%
	Fortescue Metals Group	Paul Young	A\$	22.60	18.90	-16%	Neutral	51	5.9x	8.1x	4.6%	2.8%	5.5%	1.5%
	Whitehaven Coal Ltd.	Paul Young	A\$	7.97	6.00	-25%	Sell	5	7.1x	7.5x	2.1%	1.7%	3.7%	4.6%
	New Hope Corp.	Paul Young	A\$	5.23	3.60	-31%	Sell	3	8.1x	5.7x	4.2%	5.7%	3.1%	7.9%
	Champion Iron Ltd.	Paul Young	A\$	5.00	6.00	20%	Buy	2	6.3x	7.2x	4.0%	1.5%	0.6%	2.8%
	Deterra Royalties Ltd.	Paul Young	A\$	4.50	4.50	0%	Neutral	2	11.0x	12.3x	5.3%	4.5%	7.8%	7.8%
	Vale	Marcio Farid	\$	16.58	18.00	9%	Buy	71	5.3x	6.2x	6.9%	4.7%	6.8%	4.1%
	Average								7.4x	8.0x	4.1%	3.3%	4.4%	4.4%

Closing prices as of 14-May-2026.

Time frame for price targets is 12 months

Source: Company data, FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

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Reg AC

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